

Full causal attention

	The	cat	sat	on	the
The	1	0	0	0	0
cat	1	1	0	0	0
sat	1	1	1	0	0
on	1	1	1	1	0
the	1	1	1	1	1

Each query attends to **every** previous token and itself — lower-triangular mask.

Sliding window ($w = 2$)

	The	cat	sat	on	the
The	1	0	0	0	0
cat	1	1	0	0	0
sat	0	1	1	0	0
on	0	0	1	1	0
the	0	0	0	1	1

Each query attends only within a fixed window — banded mask saves computation.

attended (1)

 masked, causal (0)

 dropped by window